

The very low figures shown for the 10-14 age group are due to the fact that quite a large number of persons in this age group are still in school and have not completed their education. It can, however be expected that when this age group moves into the 15-19 age group after 5 years, that is in 1976, the educational attainments of the 15-19 age group will be higher than that of the same group in 1971.

8.12 Higher qualifications

The total number of persons with degree, equivalent or higher qualification was 41,439 or 0.4% of the population aged 10 years and over. Of this number 29,081 were males while 12,358 were females. Thus compared to females, the number of males with higher qualifications was more than double.

In regard to the number that had passed the G.C.E. 'A' level in 3 subjects, there was a more equitable distribution between males and females. Males in this group were 56,507 compared to 41,974 females.

8.13 Consistency of reported data on literacy and educational attainment

The degree of consistency between the data on literacy and the data on educational attainment may be gauged by comparing the number reported as literate with the estimated number literate as derived from the reported educational attainments. If persons who have had some schooling are regarded as literate, and those who have had no schooling whatsoever are considered as illiterate, then the number literate can be estimated from the educational attainment as reported. The sets of data are compared in Table 8.11.

TABLE 8.11 : NUMBER REPORTED AS LITERATE COMPARED WITH THE NUMBER ESTIMATED AS LITERATE FROM THE REPORTED EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT : 1971 CENSUS

Age		Number reported as literate	Number estimated as literate from educational attainment	Difference	
				Number	Percent of number reported as literate
10 and above	T	7,344,531	7,251,002	+93,529	1.3
	M	4,143,302	4,066,239	+77,063	1.9
	F	3,201,229	3,184,763	+16,466	0.5
10 - 24	T	3,621,821	3,646,261	-24,440	-0.7
	M	1,877,442	1,894,240	-16,798	-0.9
	F	1,744,379	1,752,021	- 7,642	-0.4
25 and above	T	3,722,710	3,604,741	+17,966	0.5
	M	2,265,860	2,171,999	+93,861	4.1
	F	1,456,850	1,432,742	+24,108	1.7